

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Course code : CSE1001

Submitted by : Jenith Sharma

Registration No : 25BCY10184

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TASK 1 : *Create a digital literacy Awareness Infographic*

To design the infographic for this project, I used Canva, as it offered the flexibility required to combine informative content with an appealing visual layout. The overall structure is divided into three main sections—Digital Literacy, Safe Internet Practices, and Professional Online Presence—to provide students with a well-rounded understanding of navigating today's digital world.

The middle section mainly highlights security, incorporating simple icons such as shields and locks to stress the importance of strong passwords and proper privacy settings. The “Professional Online Presence” section is aimed at students, focusing on platforms like LinkedIn and the importance of presenting academic accomplishments effectively. I chose a clean and professional colour scheme using blue and teal shades to create a sense of trust and credibility, which is especially important when addressing topics like cybersecurity.

One aspect I found especially interesting during the design process was managing “visual hierarchy”—ensuring that the most important information stands out first without making the design feel cluttered. It was insightful to observe how strategic icon placement and bold text can significantly improve clarity and engagement.

TASK 2 : *Build your student digital portfolio*

For my professional growth over the next four years, I have chosen Stack Overflow, GitHub, and Kaggle as my key digital platforms. Each of these plays a unique role in helping me build a strong technical base while also developing a visible and credible professional presence.

GitHub will act as my main platform for version control and project management. It is where I plan to store my code, track my learning progress, and collaborate on open-source projects. Over time, I aim to create a diverse portfolio that reflects my consistency in coding and my ability to contribute effectively within a team environment.

Stack Overflow serves as my primary resource for solving problems and learning from the developer community. Although I currently use it mainly to find solutions to challenging issues, my long-term objective is to become an active contributor—answering questions to strengthen my own knowledge and establish credibility within the global tech community.

Lastly, I selected Kaggle to improve my skills in data science and machine learning. In addition to exploring datasets, I intend to take part in regular competitions and learn from expert-created notebooks. By the time I graduate, I hope to build a strong collection of high-quality work that showcases my analytical skills to future employers.

TASK 3 : *Explore coding and collaboration platform*

For this part of my project, I used CodeChef to strengthen my technical skills and Google Workspace (especially Google Forms and Google Sheets) for collaborative data handling. On CodeChef, I concentrated on Python fundamentals through my script *cse.py*. I practiced basic data processing by developing a program that computes the sum, average, and maximum value from a list of integers. This activity improved my understanding of built-in functions such as `sum()`, `len()`, and `max()`, which are crucial for developing more advanced algorithms.

At the same time, I created a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” using Google Forms to interact with my classmates. Designing five questions—ranging from multiple-choice to short-answer—helped me gain experience in structured data collection. Connecting the form to Google Sheets was especially useful, as it showed how responses can be organized and analyzed in real time.

From an academic perspective, these tools are extremely valuable. Learning platforms like CodeChef helps prepare me for competitive programming and technical interviews, keeping my core skills sharp. In addition, being proficient with Google Workspace enhances my ability to conduct research, collaborate on group projects, and manage data efficiently. Together, these skills connect theoretical programming knowledge with practical, data-driven communication.

TASK 4 : *Build your student digital project*

Through my experience of developing the “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” and practicing on CodeChef, I came to understand that effective communication is essential for success in technology. A strong real-world example of poor communication is the 2018 Hawaii false missile alert. Because of an unclear interface and misleading button labels, a government official mistakenly sent out a frightening emergency warning to the entire state. The absence of a proper confirmation step, along with confusing terminology, resulted in nearly 38 minutes of widespread panic.

To avoid similar mistakes in my future career, I aim to use platforms like GitHub and Stack Overflow to improve my clean coding practices and documentation skills. By adding meaningful comments in my programs—such as in my *cse.py* file—and writing clear explanations for my Google Form questions, I am working toward ensuring that my ideas are always clearly understood. Over the coming years, these practices will help me collaborate more effectively in team projects and build a professional profile that is both technically strong and user-friendly.

TASK 5 : Cybercrime Awareness case study and prevention guide

Studying UPI and online payment fraud was an eye-opening experience, especially because of the massive scale and rapid growth of such crimes. Recent data from National Payments Corporation of India highlights a sharp increase in fraud cases, with more than 13 lakh incidents reported within a single financial year. What stood out to me was that scammers don't rely only on technical tricks —they often use advanced psychological tactics. Through highly contextual social engineering, they can imitate a victim's recent online activity, such as searches or marketplace interactions, to quickly gain trust and manipulate them.

As a result of this research, I have decided to change my personal approach by becoming more cautious in handling digital payment requests. Earlier, I might have trusted a "Collect Request" if it appeared legitimate. Now, I follow a strict "zero-trust" approach for all financial alerts. I will never enter my PIN or scan a QR code unless I am the one initiating the transaction. Additionally, I make it a habit to carefully verify the merchant's name before completing any payment, as this simple step can significantly reduce the risk of falling victim to UPI fraud.